No one's suffering would be spared.'

They said to him in reply: 'O leader of this assembly
In this war, aid from us you will not find . . .

For rebelling against Kings is forbidden by God
To be an Amir and a Shah is quite different

We do not dare to draw swords upon him
Let whatever comes to us come.'

The Amir responded: 'Obedience to a King is right
If he is on the rightly guided path of *Shari'a*

Not a king who has become faithless
The world from his oppression would be rendered terrible

Now with the aid of infidels
He has come prepared with a great army

The helpers of infidels, by the law of the *hadith*
Become *kafirs*, wicked and impure

The killing of such an impure Shah is right
Helping him is unrighteous and wrong'

He was answered by the Qizilbash leader, Khan Shirin Khan. Dost Mohammad had a Qizilbash mother and hoped the Qizilbash would stand and fight with him, but they, like everyone else, could see which way the wind was blowing.

'Silence! [replied Khan Shirin Khan.] Do not speak words so wicked and infelicitous
For after all we have eaten the salt of the Shah

Stop your idle boasting! The time of your pretensions has gone
The time of your arrogance and vanity has passed.'

When night fell, with a hundred furies and much presumption
The Qizilbash and others worthy of the gibbet and cross . . .

Like fearless thieves plundered the treasury
They carried away much wealth and loot

Then within one night like the wind they flew
To join the Firangi army